



Inventing the Lightbulb



The invention of the electric lightbulb was certainly a 'lightbulb' moment for the world. This invention changed the way we lived, extending our days beyond the limit of natural light. Thomas Edison pioneered the spark for the electric lightbulb.

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Thomas Edison was a serial inventor. Throughout his career as a full-time inventor, he invented more than 1,000 devices on his own or with the help of others.

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Edison is best known for his invention of the domestic lightbulb. But, he was also known for the invention of the phonograph (record player) and the motion-picture player.

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Born in Ohio in 1847, Thomas experienced hearing loss at an early age and for some of his school years he was home-schooled. When he was a teenager, he worked as a telegraph operator.

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Telegraphy was an important communication service back then. Thomas was taught to send and take messages in Morse code. While he was working, he developed some improvements for these instruments. He soon decided to become a full-time inventor.

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Edison made the first practical electric light-bulb that could be used in the home. Edison worked with many other scientists in developing other inventions. This involved setting up large invention laboratories at places like Menlo Park and West Orange, New Jersey.

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Edison then went on to form companies that sold the inventions around the world. One of these big companies was General Electric. Inventing the lightbulb was a significant invention that transformed society for the modern era.

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